VILLAGE OF CALEDONIA

Caledonia Fire Department

CONTINUITY OF OPERATIONS PLAN

COOP

IAFF Local 2740 -- Caledonia Fire Department

This plan ensures the Caledonia Fire Department maintains life-safety emergency response capability and continuity of essential functions during events that disrupt normal operations -- including facility loss, significant personnel shortfalls, technology failures, and natural or man-made disasters. It establishes succession of command, alternate operating facilities, essential records protection, and a structured recovery process.

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Supersedes:	All prior informal continuity procedures
Classification:	For Official Use -- Distribute to CFD leadership and Village Emergency Management

Fire Chief Walter Leininger IV Signature: _____ Date: _____	**Village President** Tom Weatherston Signature: _____ Date: _____

SECTION 1 -- PURPOSE, APPLICABILITY, AND AUTHORITIES

1.1 Purpose

This Continuity of Operations Plan (COOP) establishes the framework for the Caledonia Fire Department (CFD) to maintain essential public safety functions during events that disrupt or threaten to disrupt normal operations. It provides CFD leadership with pre-established procedures for succession of command, alternate operating facilities, essential records protection, and recovery -- so that when something goes sideways at 0200, nobody is making it up as they go.

A COOP is not a response plan -- it is a resilience plan. Where the EOP describes how CFD responds to emergencies happening to others, this COOP describes how CFD continues to function when the emergency is happening to us.

1.2 Applicability

This plan applies to all CFD personnel, all CFD stations, and all operations -- including fire suppression, emergency medical services, and services provided to contract municipalities (Village of Wind Point and Village of North Bay). It applies equally to short-duration disruptions (a station losing power for 12 hours) and extended events (a pandemic degrading personnel availability for weeks).

1.3 Relationship to Other Plans

- Village of Caledonia Municipal EOP, Annex F (Fire & EMS): The EOP describes CFD's role in community-wide emergencies. This COOP governs CFD internal continuity and is incorporated by reference into Annex F.
- CFD Standard Operating Guidelines (SOGs): SOGs govern day-to-day operations. This COOP supersedes SOGs only where a conflict exists during a declared COOP activation.
- Racine County OEM Comprehensive Emergency Management Plan: CFD operations exist within the county framework. This COOP aligns with county continuity expectations.

1.4 Legal and Policy Basis

- Wisconsin Statute 323 -- Emergency Management
- National Incident Management System (NIMS) -- FEMA continuity guidance
- FEMA Continuity Guidance Circular (CGC) -- adapted for local fire department application
- Village of Caledonia ordinances governing emergency authority of the Village President

SECTION 2 -- THREAT AND RISK ASSESSMENT

2.1 Overview

CFD faces continuity threats across three primary categories: facility disruption, personnel disruption, and technology/systems disruption. All three are treated with equal priority -- the history of fire service continuity failures shows no single category dominates. The tornado that takes out a station, the pandemic that lays up an entire shift, and the CAD outage that leaves a dispatcher working blind are equally capable of degrading response capability when there's no plan in place.

2.2 Threat Scenarios and Primary Responses

Threat Scenario	Likelihood	Impact	Primary COOP Response
Facility loss -- Station 12 (HQ) damaged/destroyed	Low	**High**	Relocate to Station 11; activate mobile command
Facility loss -- any non-HQ station damaged/destroyed	Low	Medium	Consolidate apparatus; maintain coverage from remaining stations
Significant personnel loss (pandemic, MCI, active threat)	Medium	**Very High**	Activate callback; request MABAS personnel; adjust coverage plan
Extended personnel shortage (illness, injury surge)	Medium	**High**	Mandatory overtime; mutual aid staffing agreements
CAD system failure (ProPhoenix outage)	Medium	**High**	Revert to manual dispatch via RCCC; activate paper ICS forms
RCCC primary dispatch center outage	Low	**Very High**	RCCC activates county backup dispatch center, ESInet, & MOU with Kenosha Dispatch (county-managed)
Cyber attack / network compromise	Medium	**High**	Isolate systems; revert to paper/radio operations; notify IT
Prolonged power outage at station(s)	Medium	Medium	Activate station generators; relocate if generator fails
Loss of key leadership (Chief + multiple BCs unavailable)	Low	**High**	Succession to senior Lieutenant per chain of command policy
Active911 / alerting system outage	Medium	Medium	RCCC radio/phone alerting; Aladtec text notification; First Arriving boards as backup display
Cellular / internet infrastructure failure post-disaster	Low	**High**	FirstNet priority access activates automatically; satellite uplink requested through RCCC if needed

NOTE: Likelihood ratings (Low/Medium/High) reflect CFD's local risk profile based on Racine County hazard analysis and historical incident data. These ratings should be reviewed annually and updated based on emerging threats or changes in the regional environment.

2.3 Planning Assumptions

This COOP is built on the following assumptions:

- Any of the threat scenarios above can occur simultaneously or in combination -- a tornado can take out a station and injure personnel in the same event.

- The first 30 minutes of any COOP activation are the most critical -- pre-established procedures and a clear chain of command prevent the paralysis that kills response capability.
- CFD will exhaust all internal resources before requesting external assistance, but will not delay that request once internal resources are clearly insufficient.
- RCCC will maintain communications continuity through their county backup dispatch facility and MOU with Kenosha -- CFD does not manage dispatch redundancy independently.
- Contract municipalities (Wind Point and North Bay) will be notified immediately when their coverage is affected, and MABAS coverage will be arranged without delay.
- Cost documentation begins at hour zero of any activation -- retroactive documentation is not acceptable for FEMA reimbursement purposes.

SECTION 3 -- ESSENTIAL FUNCTIONS

3.1 Definition

Essential functions are those operations CFD must maintain regardless of the nature or severity of the disruption. Everything else -- administrative tasks, non-emergency maintenance, training activities, and routine reporting -- can be suspended or deferred during a COOP activation without compromising public safety.

If it is not on the list below, it can wait.

3.2 CFD Essential Functions

ESSENTIAL FUNCTIONS -- MUST BE MAINTAINED AT ALL TIMES

1. Fire suppression response to life-threatening emergencies within CFD's service area
2. Advanced Life Support (ALS) emergency medical response within CFD's service area
3. 24/7 staffed coverage of the Caledonia service area -- at minimum two ALS-capable companies in service
4. Radio communications with RCCC
5. Ability to request and receive MABAS mutual aid
6. Continuity of contracted fire and EMS service to Wind Point and North Bay, or immediate arrangement of alternative coverage
7. Incident Command capability -- a qualified NIMS IC available for any emergency response
8. Access to pre-incident plans for high-risk occupancies in the service area

3.3 Functions That May Be Suspended During COOP Activation

- Non-emergency building inspections and permit reviews
- Scheduled training and certification programs (safety-critical training excepted)
- Community education and outreach activities
- Routine administrative reporting (except cost documentation -- that never stops)
- Non-emergency apparatus maintenance (safety-critical maintenance excepted)
- Fire prevention program activities

3.4 Devolution of Essential Functions

When normal staffing or facilities are unavailable, essential functions devolve to alternate personnel and resources as follows:

Essential Function	Normal Lead	Devolved To	Minimum Acceptable Level
Fire suppression response	All companies	Remaining available companies + MABAS	At least 1 engine in service at all times
EMS / ALS response	CFD Paramedics	Remaining CFD medics + mutual aid EMS	At least 2 ALS units available in service area
Incident Command	Fire Chief / BC	Senior Lieutenant (per succession)	NIMS-compliant IC established within 6 min of dispatch
Dispatch coordination	RCCC (primary)	RCCC county backup dispatch center	Continuous radio contact with all apparatus

Administrative operations	Fire Chief + Admin Asst.	Battalion Chief + SharePoint access	Payroll processing; critical records accessible
Pre-plan / Active911 access	All personnel (cloud)	Printed pre-plan binders at each station	Pre-plans available for all high-risk occupancies
Public communications / PIO	Fire Chief	Designated Battalion Chief	Single spokesperson; coordinate with Village PIO
Contract municipality coverage (Wind Point, North Bay)	Normal CFD response	MABAS coverage requested immediately upon resource commitment	Continuous coverage -- notify municipality leadership

SECTION 4 -- SUCCESSION OF COMMAND AND DELEGATION OF AUTHORITY

4.1 Succession of Command

CFD maintains a documented succession of command to ensure uninterrupted leadership authority at all times. Succession is based on position, not individual -- the plan does not depend on any specific person being available. The succession order below reflects CFD's existing chain of command policy and extends it to explicitly cover COOP scenarios.

Order	Position	Current Authority Level	Activation Condition
1st	**Fire Chief**	Full authority -- all operational, administrative, and fiscal decisions	Always in effect
2nd	On-Duty Battalion Chief	Full operational authority; administrative/fiscal authority during Chief absence	Chief unavailable or incapacitated
3rd	Senior Off-Duty Battalion Chief	Full operational authority; administrative/fiscal authority as needed	Chief and on-duty BC both unavailable
4th	Senior On-Duty Lieutenant	Operational authority for immediate incident/shift management	All Battalion Chiefs unavailable
5th	Senior Off-Duty Lieutenant	Operational authority -- called back to assume command	All BCs and on-duty Lieutenants unavailable

IMPORTANT: A succession officer assumes authority automatically when the officer above them is confirmed unavailable or incapacitated. Notification to RCCC and the Village President is required whenever succession below the Battalion Chief level is activated.

4.2 Authority Delegated During COOP Activation

The following authorities are pre-delegated to the succession officer upon activation:

- Commit CFD apparatus and personnel to emergency operations
- Authorize mandatory overtime and callback of off-duty personnel
- Request MABAS mutual aid
- Authorize emergency purchases necessary for life safety operations (notify Finance Director within 24 hours)
- Serve as or designate the CFD spokesperson for media and public communications
- Make operational decisions regarding station relocation and apparatus deployment

Authorities NOT delegated below the rank of Battalion Chief without explicit authorization from the Fire Chief:

- Modification of inter-municipal service agreements with Wind Point or North Bay
- Suspension of a contractual service obligation
- Any expenditure exceeding the emergency purchasing threshold established by Village ordinance
- Formal request for Wisconsin National Guard assistance

4.3 Notification Requirements

When succession is activated at any level, the following notifications shall be made as soon as operationally practical:

9. RCCC -- advise of COOP activation and identify succession officer in command

10. Racine County OEM -- advise of activation and any resource needs
11. Village President -- advise of COOP status; brief on situation and expected duration
12. Village Emergency Management Coordinator -- coordinate with municipal EOP if applicable
13. Wind Point and North Bay -- advise of any change in service coverage
14. Off-duty CFD leadership -- ensure all Battalion Chiefs are aware regardless of availability

SECTION 5 -- ALTERNATE FACILITIES AND RELOCATION

5.1 Primary and Alternate Operating Facilities

CFD's primary headquarters is Station 12 at 5045 Chester Lane, which opened in 2024 and serves as the administrative and operational center for the department. In the event Station 12 is unavailable, command and administration relocates in the following order:

Priority	Facility	Address	Capability Notes
Primary HQ	**Station 12 -- Chester Lane (HQ)**	5045 Chester Lane, Caledonia, WI	Administrative HQ; opened 2024; primary command and administrative center
1st Alternate	Station 11 -- Nicholson Rd	6900 Nicholson Rd, Caledonia, WI	Former HQ (pre-2024); full station capability; familiar to all personnel
2nd Alternate	Station 10 -- Northwestern Ave	9433 Northwestern Ave, Caledonia, WI	Full station capability; western service area coverage maintained
3rd Alternate	Mobile Command (Battalion vehicle)	Deployable anywhere in service area	Operational command only; no administrative/records capability
EOC Fallback	Racine County EOC	717 Wisconsin Ave, Racine, WI	Available for CFD use per county EOP; coordinate through Racine County OEM

5.2 Relocation Triggers

Relocation from the primary facility shall be initiated when any of the following conditions exist:

- Structural damage rendering Station 12 unsafe for occupancy
- Loss of utilities (power, heat, water) that cannot be restored within 4-6 hours via generator or repair
- Active hazmat contamination of the facility or immediate surroundings
- Direction from the Village Emergency Management Coordinator or Incident Commander
- Any condition that, in the judgment of the senior officer present, makes continued operations from Station 12 unsafe or operationally unsound

5.3 Relocation Procedures

15. Senior officer on duty declares relocation and designates alternate facility.
16. Notify RCCC of new operational address.
17. Secure or transfer critical records and equipment from Station 12 if safe to do so.
18. Confirm apparatus assignments for coverage from alternate location.
19. Notify Village President and Racine County OEM of relocation.
20. If Station 11 is designated, confirm administrative systems are accessible (SharePoint/phone services/ProPhoenix RMS via laptop/mobile).
21. Establish temporary administrative workspace; confirm contact information is updated with RCCC.

5.4 Station Generator Status

Each CFD station is equipped with a backup generator. Generator readiness is a critical continuity asset -- a station that loses commercial power but retains generator power remains fully operational. Generators run an automatic startup and transfer switch test weekly. Generators are given a full service annually. Last full-service dates: 6900 Nicholson Rd -- 12/17/2025; 9433 Northwestern Ave -- 1/21/2026; 5045 Chester Lane -- 11/06/2025. All generators run off WE Energies supplied natural gas.

NOTE: Generator maintenance records at attached (and automatic transfer switch test schedules are automatically performed by each generator programming at each station on a weekly basis. Confirm service agreements and weekly tests as required Include in annual COOP review.

5.5 Minimum Equipment at Alternate Facility

When operating from an alternate facility, the following minimum equipment and materials shall be transferred or pre-positioned:

- Laptop with SharePoint access and CFD administrative files
- Printed copy of this COOP and the CFD EOP Annex F
- Printed personnel callback list (current within 30 days)
- Printed MABAS cards (current)
- Printed pre-plan binders for high-risk occupancies
- Blank paper ICS forms (ICS 201, 211, 214) and paper PCR forms
- Command radio and charger
- Emergency Expenditures authorization Policy Sec. 2-4-26
- Department Credit Cards

SECTION 6 -- COOP ACTIVATION CHECKLIST

This checklist is the primary operational tool for COOP activation. The officer initiating COOP activation is responsible for working through this checklist and delegating tasks as appropriate. Print and retain a completed copy as part of the incident record.

IMPORTANT: Begin cost documentation at the moment of activation, not after. Time-stamped records from hour zero are required for FEMA Public Assistance reimbursement eligibility.

Done	Action	Who
IMMEDIATE (0-30 MINUTES)		
[ ]	Declare COOP activation -- verbal notification to on-duty personnel	Fire Chief / BC
[ ]	Account for all on-duty personnel -- confirm no injuries	On-Duty BC
[ ]	Notify RCCC of COOP status and any operational changes	Fire Chief / BC
[ ]	Notify Racine County OEM -- [phone number: insert]	Fire Chief
[ ]	Activate succession officer if Chief or BC is incapacitated	Senior officer present
[ ]	Assess immediate threat -- is current facility safe to operate from?	On-Duty BC
[ ]	If facility unsafe: initiate relocation to Station 11 (6900 Nicholson Rd)	On-Duty BC
[ ]	Request MABAS mutual aid if personnel/apparatus below minimum staffing	Fire Chief / BC
[ ]	Notify Wind Point and North Bay if their coverage is affected	Fire Chief
SHORT-TERM (30 MIN - 24 HOURS)		
[ ]	Brief all on-duty personnel on COOP status and role assignments	Fire Chief / BC
[ ]	Initiate mandatory callback via Active911 and/or Aladtec text notification if below minimum staffing	On-Duty BC
[ ]	Begin disaster cost documentation -- record all expenditures from hour 0	Admin Asst. / BC
[ ]	Assess status of all critical systems (ProPhoenix, Active911, SharePoint, ImageTrend)	Fire Chief / Admin
[ ]	Activate paper ICS forms and paper ePCR forms if electronic systems unavailable	On-Duty BC
[ ]	Confirm pre-plan binder availability at affected station(s)	Company Officer
[ ]	Notify Village President and Emergency Management Coordinator	Fire Chief
[ ]	Establish media communications protocol -- single spokesperson designated	Fire Chief
[ ]	Conduct first personnel accountability check -- all shift personnel confirmed	On-Duty BC
[ ]	If cellular/internet infrastructure is degraded: notify RCCC to initiate FirstNet satellite uplink request if needed	Fire Chief / BC
SUSTAINED (24+ HOURS)		
[ ]	Brief incoming shifts on COOP status at every shift change	On-Duty BC
[ ]	Daily situation report to Village President and Racine County OEM	Fire Chief
[ ]	Continue cost documentation -- submit daily summary to Finance Director	Admin Asst.
[ ]	Coordinate facility repair / system restoration timeline with appropriate vendors	Fire Chief
[ ]	Monitor personnel fatigue -- adjust schedules as operationally safe	Fire Chief / BC

[ ]	Evaluate MABAS mutual aid needs -- extend or release as appropriate	Fire Chief
[ ]	Review and update COOP status at each operational period (12-24 hour intervals)	Fire Chief
RECOVERY / RECONSTITUTION		
[ ]	Declare end of COOP activation -- notify RCCC, OEM, Village, contract municipalities	Fire Chief
[ ]	Return to primary facility and restore normal operations	Fire Chief
[ ]	Conduct after-action review (AAR) with all involved personnel within 14 days	Fire Chief
[ ]	Document all lessons learned and update this COOP accordingly	Fire Chief / Admin
[ ]	Submit final cost documentation package to Finance Director	Admin Asst.
[ ]	Brief Village leadership on outcome and any recommended improvements	Fire Chief

SECTION 7 -- ESSENTIAL RECORDS AND SYSTEMS PROTECTION

7.1 Overview

CFD's ability to resume normal operations after a disruption depends heavily on the availability of essential records and operational systems. This section identifies what must be protected, where it lives, and what the backup plan is when primary access is lost.

CFD's Village IT infrastructure provides strong data protection at multiple levels. SharePoint Online data is stored redundantly across multiple Microsoft datacenters worldwide, backed up every 12 hours with backups retained for 14 days. The Village's physical server is located at the Public Safety Building (Station 12); the Microsoft Azure environment is fully virtualized so that in the event of a natural disaster or facility loss, Village systems can switch to running in the Azure cloud with minimal downtime. All data is backed up daily to the cloud and can be restored into that virtualized environment. For CFD, this means records stored in SharePoint, ProPhoenix (hosted), ImageTrend (cloud), and Lexipol (cloud) have robust protection. The primary residual risk is files stored only on the local Station 12 server that are not actively syncing to SharePoint -- those should be verified quarterly.

7.2 Essential Records Inventory

Record / System	Primary Location	Backup Location	Owner / Access
Personnel files (employment, certifications, medical)	Local server -- Station 12	SharePoint (verify sync)	Fire Chief / Admin Asst.
Standard Operating Guidelines (SOGs)	Lexipol (cloud)	SharePoint (verify sync)	Fire Chief
Apparatus records (specs, maintenance, NIMS typing)	ProPhoenix + local server	Paper files -- Station 12 admin office	Admin Asst. / Fleet
Pre-incident plans	Active911 (cloud)	Printed copies at each station	Company Officers
CAD incident history	ProPhoenix (hosted)	Contact ProPhoenix for recovery	Admin Asst.
ePCR / EMS patient records	ImageTrend (cloud)	ImageTrend hosted -- contact vendor	EMS Officer
Mutual aid / MABAS cards	Station 12 admin office	SharePoint and all station copies	Fire Chief
Fiscal / budget records	Village Finance (SharePoint)	Village Finance Dept. backup	Finance Director
Personnel contact / callback list	Active911; Station 12 admin	Printed copy -- each station + Chief	Admin Asst.
Inter-municipal service agreements	Village Clerk's office	SharePoint / Fire Chief copy	Village Clerk / Chief
This COOP and EOP documents	SharePoint	Printed copy -- Station 12 and Station 11	Fire Chief / Admin Asst.

NOTE: Village IT has confirmed robust data protection: SharePoint Online is backed up every 12 hours with 14-day retention across multiple worldwide datacenters; the Azure environment is fully virtualized so systems can failover to cloud with minimal downtime; all data is backed up daily to the cloud and restorable to the virtual environment. The remaining housekeeping item is verifying that files stored only on the Station 12 local server are actively syncing to SharePoint. Confirm sync status quarterly during routine IT check-ins.

7.3 Systems Continuity

System	Vendor / Host	Outage Response	Recovery Contact
ProPhoenix CAD	ProPhoenix (hosted)	Manual dispatch via RCCC radio; paper run reports	ProPhoenix support line -- 609-953-6850
Active911	Active911 (cloud)	RCCC radio alerting; Aladtec text notification; printed pre-plan binders	Active911 support – support@active911.com 541-223-7992
ImageTrend ePCR	ImageTrend (cloud)	Paper PCR forms in all ALS apparatus	ImageTrend support – support@imagetrend.com 888-730-3255 M-F 6-8pm
SharePoint / M365	Microsoft (cloud)	Azure virtualized environment activates with minimal downtime; daily cloud backup restorable to virtual environment; local cached copies on laptops; USB backup at Station 12	IT contact -- Village of Caledonia IT 262-293-9967
Aladtec	Aladtec (cloud)	Direct phone contact via printed callback list	Aladtec support -- aladtec.com 888-749-5550
RCCC CAD / Radio	Racine County (primary)	RCCC activates county backup dispatch center	Racine County OEM 262-636-3515
First Arriving	First Arriving (cloud)	Boards display last known data; radio backup	First Arriving support – support@firstarriving.com 240-667-7755
FirstNet	AT&T (FirstNet)	Priority access automatic on enrolled devices; satellite uplink via RCCC request	Via RCCC --> Racine County OEM (CFD does not contact AT&T directly)
Station generators	On-site (each station)	Automatic transfer switch; manual start if needed	Facilities contact Ryan Schmidt 262-939-5394

NOTE: Support line phone numbers should be verified and documented as this documented is updated each year.

7.4 Records Protection Actions

- Printed copies of this COOP and CFD EOP Annex F shall be maintained at Station 12 and Station 11 at all times, updated with each revision.
- A current printed personnel callback list shall be posted at the watch desk of each station and updated whenever personnel changes occur.
- Printed MABAS cards shall be maintained at all stations and in the Battalion Chief command vehicle.
- Printed pre-plan binders for all high-risk occupancies shall be maintained at each station. Active911 is the primary system; binders are the backup.
- A USB drive containing current SOGs, apparatus records, and key administrative documents shall be stored in the Station 12 fire safe and updated quarterly.

SECTION 8 -- PERSONNEL AND STAFFING CONTINUITY

8.1 Minimum Staffing Standards

CFD must maintain minimum staffing levels to fulfill its essential functions during a COOP activation. The following standards apply:

Condition	Minimum Staffing Standard	Authority to Modify
Normal Operations	Per current CFD SOG (sworn staffing per shift per station)	Fire Chief
COOP Activation -- Level 1 (one threat scenario active)	Maintain normal minimum; initiate callback for any position below minimums	Battalion Chief on duty
COOP Activation -- Level 2 (multiple scenarios / sustained)	Mandatory overtime; consolidate apparatus to maintain ALS coverage in all response zones	Fire Chief or designee
COOP Activation -- Level 3 (catastrophic / extended)	Request MABAS mutual aid staffing; coordinate with Racine County OEM for regional personnel resources	Fire Chief; notify Village President

8.2 Callback Procedures

When on-duty staffing falls below minimum levels due to a COOP event:

22. On-duty Battalion Chief initiates callback via Active911 and/or Aladtec text notification and/or direct phone contact.
23. Callback priority follows the established CFD overtime callback list per current SOG.
24. If internal callback cannot fill positions within 2 hours, Fire Chief authorizes MABAS mutual aid staffing request through RCCC.
25. All callback personnel are briefed on COOP status at the time of notification.
26. Hours worked by callback personnel are documented from the time of notification, not from time of arrival.

NOTE: Aladtec text/push notification provides a secondary alerting channel for callback separate from Active911. Both systems can be activated simultaneously for maximum personnel reach. Aladtec notification timestamps also serve as documentation for FEMA PA personnel cost records.

8.3 Extended Personnel Shortage (Pandemic / Mass Casualty)

A pandemic or mass casualty event affecting CFD personnel is the highest-impact personnel threat CFD faces. When personnel availability drops significantly and is expected to remain degraded for an extended period:

- Fire Chief contacts Racine County OEM to advise of personnel emergency and request regional coordination.
- CFD evaluates consolidation of apparatus to maintain ALS coverage across the service area with reduced staffing.
- Contract municipality obligations are reviewed -- Wind Point and North Bay are notified, and MABAS staffing coverage is requested if CFD cannot fulfill contractual obligations.
- Shift lengths and overtime authorization may be extended beyond normal SOG limits with Fire Chief approval -- fatigue management becomes an active safety concern.
- Wisconsin Emergency Management (WEM) can coordinate inter-county personnel mutual aid for extended personnel shortfalls -- request through Racine County OEM.

MUTUAL AID STAFFING -- PLANNING NOTE: MABAS Division 102 is CFD's primary mutual aid framework and covers the substantial majority of disaster resource needs -- apparatus, crews, and specialized resources -- through a formalized, annually-updated structure that FEMA already recognizes for reimbursement purposes. No additional bilateral agreements are needed to supplement MABAS for incident-based mutual aid. The narrow remaining gap is extended shift-fill staffing during prolonged personnel shortages (pandemic, sustained injury surge) where a neighboring department's personnel would be borrowed to fill a vacancy for days or weeks rather than respond to a specific incident. For this scenario, CFD should pursue a simple Letter of Agreement (LOA) or MOU with South Shore Fire (shared Station 10 relationship makes this a natural fit) covering reciprocal personnel loan-out during declared emergencies. Existing one-off handshake arrangements with nearby municipalities for single engine or ambulance requests are acceptable operationally; brief written LOAs for those relationships would strengthen FEMA PA documentation if costs are ever submitted. Consult IAFF Local 2740 before finalizing any personnel loan-out agreement. See companion LOA template document for draft language.

8.4 Personnel Accountability During COOP

Personnel accountability does not stop during a COOP activation -- it becomes more critical. The on-duty Battalion Chief is responsible for maintaining accountability of all on-duty personnel at all times during an activation. Accountability checks shall be conducted at each shift change and whenever personnel assignments change due to the COOP event.

SECTION 9 -- COMMUNICATIONS CONTINUITY

9.1 Primary Dispatch -- RCCC

Racine County Communications Center (RCCC) provides primary dispatch and communications coordination for all CFD operations. RCCC dispatches police, fire, and EMS for all municipalities in Racine County from a centralized facility. CFD does not operate an independent dispatch center.

9.2 RCCC Backup Dispatch

Racine County maintains a backup dispatch facility to ensure continuity of county-wide communications if the primary RCCC facility becomes unavailable. The backup center is activated by RCCC all 911 line are automatically transferred to neighboring PSAPs via the statewide ESInet. An MOU with Kenosha dispatch is in place should they need each other space or assistance. Activation of the backup center is a county-managed function -- CFD does not initiate this process independently.

9.3 CFD Radio Communications Backup

- All CFD apparatus carry multi-channel portable and mobile radios capable of operating on primary, tactical, and interoperability channels. Including several simplex channels if radio repeating towers are down.
- The Battalion Chief command vehicle serves as a mobile communications platform capable of supporting field command if station-based communications are disrupted. Utility 12 can also serve as a mobile communications platform capable of supporting field command.
- CFD portable radios carry a minimum charge standard -- charging discipline at all stations is a COOP readiness issue, not just an operational preference.
- In the event of total radio failure, CFD will revert to cell phone or land line coordination through RCCC until radio systems are restored. Members will keep track of on-scene, transporting, and in-service times.

9.4 Personnel Notification -- Aladtec

CFD uses Aladtec for personnel scheduling and workforce management. Aladtec's built-in text message and push notification capability serves as an additional channel for alerting off-duty personnel during activations, disaster callbacks, and major incidents.

- Aladtec notification is initiated by the on-duty Battalion Chief or Fire Chief through the Aladtec web or mobile interface.
- Aladtec and Active911 may be activated simultaneously for maximum personnel reach -- Aladtec is the complement, not the replacement, for Active911 during large-scale activations or off-duty callback.
- Aladtec notification timestamps provide documented records of when personnel were contacted, supporting FEMA PA cost documentation for overtime and callback personnel.
- If Active911 is unavailable, Aladtec serves as the primary electronic notification platform, with the printed callback list as the ultimate fallback.

9.5 Internal CFD Communications During COOP

- Active911 is the primary platform for personnel alerting and notification. If Active911 is unavailable, RCCC radio, Aladtec text notification, and direct phone contact via the printed callback list are the backups in that order.
- First Arriving digital display boards at each station provide secondary alerting and situational awareness. If cloud connectivity is lost, boards display no data.
- The printed personnel callback list maintained at each station watch desk is the ultimate backup for personnel notification when all electronic systems are unavailable.

9.6 FirstNet -- Priority Cellular and Post-Disaster Connectivity

CFD personnel who carry FirstNet-enabled devices have priority access to AT&T's dedicated public safety broadband network. FirstNet provides preemptive access during network congestion and supports voice, data, and application connectivity when commercial cellular networks are overloaded or degraded during a major incident or disaster.

Post-disaster cellular and internet restoration -- Emergency Satellite Uplink:

- When commercial cellular and internet infrastructure is damaged or destroyed following a disaster, FirstNet can deploy portable satellite-based uplink equipment -- including Satellite Cell on Light Trucks (SatCOLT) and other deployable assets -- to restore connectivity for public safety operations.
- All requests by CFD for FirstNet deployable assets or emergency satellite uplink must be made through Racine County Communications Center (RCCC). CFD does not contact FirstNet/AT&T directly for deployable asset requests.
- RCCC coordinates FirstNet deployable asset requests through Racine County OEM, who escalates to Wisconsin Emergency Management (WEM) and the AT&T FirstNet response team as appropriate.
- CFD's designated EOC Representative is responsible for communicating FirstNet connectivity needs to the EOC so that RCCC/OEM can initiate the request on CFD's behalf.
- FirstNet priority access is automatic on enrolled devices during declared emergencies -- no manual activation step is required for standard priority data and voice service.

NOTE: FirstNet deployable asset deployment timelines vary based on asset availability and the scale of the disaster. Do not assume immediate satellite uplink availability -- plan for extended periods of degraded connectivity and maintain paper-based backup procedures for dispatch, ePCR documentation, and cost tracking throughout any activation.

9.7 External Communications During COOP

- A single designated spokesperson (Fire Chief, or designee per succession) handles all media and public communications during a COOP activation.
- The Village PIO will be coordinated with for any community-wide public communications.
- Racine County OEM will be updated at regular intervals (minimum every 12 hours for activations exceeding 24 hours).
- Wind Point and North Bay leadership will be notified immediately when coverage changes and updated as the situation evolves.

SECTION 10 -- PLAN MAINTENANCE AND TESTING

10.1 Review Schedule

A COOP that is not reviewed is a COOP that will fail when you need it. The following triggers require plan review and update:

Review Trigger	Who Reviews	Action Required
Annual (Q1 each year)	Fire Chief + Battalion Chiefs	Full plan review; update all contacts, facilities, resources, and gap status
Following any COOP activation	Fire Chief + involved personnel	AAR within 14 days; update plan based on lessons learned
Significant personnel change (Chief, BCs)	Fire Chief	Update succession table and delegation of authority section
Apparatus or station changes	Fire Chief / Admin Asst.	Update facility and resource tables
MABAS card revision	Fire Chief	Update mutual aid references
Change in contract municipality agreements	Fire Chief	Update devolution and coverage sections
Technology system change (new CAD, new MDT)	Fire Chief / Admin Asst.	Update systems continuity table

10.2 Testing and Exercises

CFD shall conduct at least one planned exercise annually that tests COOP procedures. Exercise formats may include:

- Tabletop exercise -- discuss a scenario, walk through decisions, identify gaps. Low cost, high value.
- Functional exercise -- activate specific COOP elements (e.g., test the relocation procedure to Station 11) without a full operational disruption.
- Full-scale exercise -- full activation of COOP procedures, coordinated with Racine County OEM and contract municipalities.

Exercise findings shall be documented in an after-action report and used to update this plan. The goal is to find the gaps in a training environment, not during an actual event.

10.3 Distribution and Accessibility

- This COOP shall be stored on SharePoint and accessible to all CFD Battalion Chiefs and above from any device.
- Printed copies shall be maintained at Station 12 and Station 11, updated with each revision.
- The activation checklist (Section 6) shall be printed and laminated, posted at the watch desk of Station 12 and Station 11, and carried in the Battalion Chief command vehicle.
- The Fire Chief is responsible for ensuring all Battalion Chiefs have read and are familiar with this plan.

10.4 Plan Ownership

The Fire Chief is the owner and final authority for this COOP. The Administrative Assistant maintains version control and distribution. Battalion Chiefs are responsible for operational familiarity and for providing feedback that informs updates.

ANNEX APPROVAL AND SIGNATURES

Fire Chief	**Village President**
Walter Leininger IV	Tom Weatherston
Signature: _____	Signature: _____
Date: _____	Date: _____

-- End of CFD Continuity of Operations Plan --